

# Writing to GCP(google cloud) lakehouse runtime catalog iceberg tables with dbt

Masaya Kameyama

2026-08-24

## Introduction

AI . dbt lakehouse runtime catalog 3 .  
 , GCP lakehouse runtime catalog snowflake . 2 , bigquery lakehouse runtime catalog , , bigquery DDL/DDL lakehouse runtime catalog iceberg table .  
 , dbt bigquery native table , (gold) lakehouse runtime catalog iceberg table . , dbt , , , .  
 , 2026 8 .

## bigquery lakehouse runtime catalog

lakehouse runtime catalog bigquery , 4 . managed iceberg table , :

```
CREATE TABLE `PROJECT_ID.CATALOG_ID.NAMESPACE.TABLE_NAME` (id int, data string);  
INSERT INTO `PROJECT_ID.CATALOG_ID.NAMESPACE.TABLE_NAME` VALUES (1, "foo");
```

```
managed iceberg table WITH CONNECTION OPTIONS(file_format, table_format,  
storage_uri) . , CATALOG_ID ID . catalog_type CATALOG_TYPE_GCS_BUCKET  
 . UPDATE / DELETE / MERGE .
```

```
gcp.biglake.bigquery-dml.enabled . bigquery DDL , big-  
query DML . spark OSS , bigquery SELECT , DML
```

DML statements are only supported over tables that have data stored in BigQuery.

`TBLPROPERTIES` `ALTER TABLE` `bigquery DML` `iceberg`  
`table` ,  
 , set up `bigquery DDL/DML` ,

## terraform

`namespace terraform` `bigquery CREATE TABLE namespace` , `names-`  
`pace` :

```

resource "google_storage_bucket" "lakehouse" {
  name                = "my-lakehouse-bucket"
  location             = "us-central1"
  force_destroy       = true
  uniform_bucket_level_access = true
}

resource "google_biglake_iceberg_catalog" "main" {
  name                = google_storage_bucket.lakehouse.name
  catalog_type        = "CATALOG_TYPE_GCS_BUCKET"
  credential_mode      = "CREDENTIAL_MODE_VENDED_CREDENTIALS"
  primary_location    = "us-central1"
}

resource "google_biglake_iceberg_namespace" "gold" {
  catalog      = google_biglake_iceberg_catalog.main.name
  namespace_id = "gold"
}

# vended credentials
# GCS metadata/data ,
resource "google_storage_bucket_iam_member" "catalog_agent" {
  bucket = google_storage_bucket.lakehouse.name
  role    = "roles/storage.objectAdmin"
  member  = "serviceAccount:${google_biglake_iceberg_catalog.main.biglake_service_account}"
}

```

`IAM` , `storage.objects.create` denied 403 . vended credentials `GC-`  
`S` , `GCS` .

## dbt

`dbt 1.10 catalogs.yml` , `dbt-bigquery catalog_type: biglake_metastore` .  
`bigquery managed iceberg table` . , `iceberg` `table_format /`

```

file_format / storage_uri OPTIONS ,      3 project.dataset.table . catalog
integration biglake_metastore1 ,      managed_iceberg .

, dbt core Relation database.schema.identifier 3 . lakehouse runtime cat-
alog project, catalog, namespace, table 4 , .

```

Relation , config 4 DDL/DML . :

```

{% macro lakehouse_iceberg_merge_sql(table_ref, source_sql, column_names, unique_keys) %}
  {%- set update_columns = column_names | reject('in', unique_keys) | list -%}
  merge into {{ table_ref }} as dbt_dest
  using (
    {{ source_sql }}
  ) as dbt_src
  on
    {%- for key in unique_keys %}
    {{ 'and' if not loop.first }} dbt_dest.`{ key }` = dbt_src.`{ key }`
    {%- endfor %}
  {% if update_columns | length > 0 -%}
  when matched then update set
    {%- for col in update_columns %}
    `{ col }` = dbt_src.`{ col }`{{ ' , ' if not loop.last }}
    {%- endfor %}
  {% endif -%}
  when not matched then insert
    ({{ for col in column_names %}}`{ col }`{{ ' , ' if not loop.last }}{% endfor %})
  values
    ({{ for col in column_names %}}dbt_src.`{ col }`{{ ' , ' if not loop.last }}{% endfor %})
{% endmacro %}

{% materialization lakehouse_iceberg, adapter='bigquery' %}

  {%- set identifier = model['alias'] -%}
  {%- set catalog = var('iceberg_catalog') -%}
  {%- set namespace = var('iceberg_namespace') -%}
  {%- set table_ref = '`' ~ target.project ~ '.' ~ catalog ~ '.' ~ namespace ~ '.' ~ identifier ~ '`' -%}

  {%- set unique_key = config.get('unique_key') -%}
  {%- set unique_keys = [unique_key] if unique_key is string else (unique_key or []) -%}
  {%- set full_refresh_mode = should_full_refresh() -%}

```

```

{{ run_hooks(pre_hooks) }}

{%- 4 Relation get_columns_in_relation .
    compiled SQL -#}
{%- set columns = adapter.get_column_schema_from_query(get_empty_subquery_sql(sql)) -%}
{%- set column_names = columns | map(attribute='name') | list -%}
{%- set column_ddl = [] -%}
{%- for c in columns -%}
    {%- do column_ddl.append('`' ~ c.name ~ '`' ~ c.data_type) -%}
{%- endfor -%}

{% if full_refresh_mode %}
    {% do run_query('drop table if exists ' ~ table_ref) %}
{% endif %}

{% do run_query('create table if not exists ' ~ table_ref ~ ' (' ~ column_ddl | join(', ')

{% call statement('main') %}
    {% if unique_keys | length > 0 and not full_refresh_mode %}
        {{ lakehouse_iceberg_merge_sql(table_ref, sql, column_names, unique_keys) }}
    {% else %}
        insert into {{ table_ref }}
            ({{ for col in column_names }}`{{ col }}`{{ ', ' if not loop.last }}{% endfor %})
        select {{ for col in column_names }}`{{ col }}`{{ ', ' if not loop.last }}{% endfor %}
        from (
            {{ sql }}
        )
    {% endif %}
{% endcall %}

{{ run_hooks(post_hooks) }}

{%- 4 iceberg table relation cache -#}
{{ return({'relations': []}) }}

{% endmaterialization %}

```

3 .

. 4 Relation adapter.get\_columns\_in\_relation . get\_empty\_subquery\_sql compiled SQL where false limit 0 , adapter.get\_column\_schema\_from\_query bigquery . dbt contract .

. run CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS MERGE . INSERT ,

2 . --full-refresh DROP → CREATE → INSERT ... SELECT .

```
return({'relations': []}) . dbt relation cache , 3 relation dbt .
```

:

```
{{ config(
    materialized='lakehouse_iceberg',
    schema='gold',
    unique_key=['event_date', 'tenant_id']
) }}
```

```
select
    event_date,
    tenant_id,
    impressions,
    clicks,
    current_timestamp() as loaded_at
from {{ ref('int_events_daily') }}
```

```
CREATE TABLE INSERT ... VALUES , dbt . :
```

---

```
CREATE TABLE( )
INSERT ... VALUES
INSERT ... SELECT(native table → iceberg table)
MERGE(native table USING )
CREATE TABLE AS SELECT
```

---

```
native table iceberg table INSERT ... SELECT MERGE , . INSERT ...
VALUES , dbt .
```

```
dbt . loaded_at current_timestamp() :
```

- 1 run: CREATE TABLE + MERGE
- 2 run: loaded\_at . MERGE
- --full-refresh: dbt MERGE INSERT , GCS ID

```
lakehouse runtime catalog , 3 .
```

1. gold bigquery dataset . managed iceberg table dataset
2. iceberg REST API

GET https://biglake.googleapis.com/iceberg/v1/restcatalog/v1/projects/PROJECT\_ID/catalogs/CA

```
{ "identifiers": [ { "namespace": ["gold"], "name": "gold_events_daily" } ] }
```

### 3. iceberg

pyiceberg . spark trino :

```
import google.auth
import google.auth.transport.requests
from pyiceberg.catalog.rest import RestCatalog

creds, _ = google.auth.default(scopes=["https://www.googleapis.com/auth/cloud-platform"])
creds.refresh(google.auth.transport.requests.Request())

catalog = RestCatalog("main", **{
    "uri": "https://biglake.googleapis.com/iceberg/v1/restcatalog",
    #      400
    "warehouse": "gs://my-lakehouse-bucket",
    "token": creds.token,
    "header.x-goog-user-project": "PROJECT_ID",
    "header.X-Iceberg-Access-Delegation": "vended-credentials",
    # RestCatalog OAuth ADC
    "rest.auth.type": "noop",
})

t = catalog.load_table("gold.gold_events_daily")
print(t.current_snapshot())
print(t.scan().to_arrow())
```

pyiceberg[gcsfs] FileIO load\_table , pyiceberg[pyarrow,gcsfs] <sup>1</sup>.

loaded\_at dbt run . EXPORT TABLE METADATA , dbt bigquery .  
export , .

### 3

- . relation cache , ref() . iceberg table dbt , -  
gold

---

<sup>1</sup> , ADC quota\_project\_id , API .  
UserProjectAccountProblem 403 . gcloud config set project gcloud auth  
application-default set-quota-project .

- `dbt test dbt docs` . 3 relation . silver , iceberg table 4
- . `CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS` , `--full-refresh`

,

- `DROP TABLE GCS` . , metadata parquet . `--full-refresh` ,
- **native table iceberg table** . bigquery US us-central1 ,  
 . silver dataset , `INSERT ... SELECT`
- . 3 . GA

, dbt . dbt-bigquery Relation 4 , `catalogs.yml` lakehouse runtime catalog catalog type , .

## Summary

- 2 bigquery lakehouse runtime catalog , . ``PROJECT_ID.CATALOG_ID.NAMESP`  
`WITH CONNECTION OPTIONS DDL/DML` .
- `gcp.biglake.bigquery-dml.enabled` , bigquery , OS-S
- `dbt-bigquery catalogs.yml(catalog_type: biglake_metastore)` managed iceberg table , dbt core Relation 3 , lakehouse runtime catalog
- 4 , bigquery native table , lakehouse runtime catalog iceberg table . `get_column_schema_from_query get_empty_subquery_sql` ,  
`run MERGE, --full-refresh DROP → CREATE → INSERT ... SELECT` .
- `INSERT ... SELECT, MERGE(native source USING), CREATE TABLE AS SELECT` . bigquery dataset , iceberg REST API pyiceberg . `EXPORT TABLE METADATA` .
- iceberg table ( `ref()` ) , `dbt test / dbt docs` . `DROP TABLE GCS` , native table .